Review Form – ICBET 2026

Paper ID: **BA0057**

Paper Title: **Towards a Human-Guided AutoML Application for Democratizing Predictive Modeling in Clinical Research**

Evaluation Summary

Evaluation Criteria	Score (1 = Low / Poor, 5 = High / Excellent)
1. Relevance to Conference Themes	4
2. Clarity and Organization of the Paper	3
3. Scientific Merit / Originality	4
4. Technical Quality	3
5. Figures and Tables	3
6. Language and Style	3
7. References and Background	3

Overall Recommendation:

☐ Accept

☐ Accept with Minor Revision

☐ **Accept with Major Revision**

☐ Reject

Comments and Suggestions for Improvement:

1. The paper addresses an important and timely problem: the gap between advanced machine learning techniques and their practical usability by clinical researchers. The motivation is well articulated, and the focus on human-guided machine learning (HGML) and protocol-aware AutoML systems is both relevant and novel. Despite its conceptual strengths, the paper has several important limitations:
2. The contribution is primarily system design and interface innovation, rather than methodological or algorithmic advancement. The backend relies on an existing AutoML engine (Ludwig), and no new modeling techniques are introduced.
3. Although the system is developed with clinical researchers, no formal user study is presented.
4. The participatory design is described, but evidence remains anecdotal rather than systematic.
5. The manuscript does not follow the IEEE conference formatting guidelines.